Loratadine

Mechanism of action

- Loratadine is a non-sedating antihistamine.
- Loratadine antagonises (blocks) peripheral histamine receptors, blocking the action of histamine and reducing itching and redness.

Authorised practice levels

- EMTs, Paramedics, ICPs and CCPs.

Indications

- ✓ Minor allergic reactions confined to skin involvement.
- ✓ Itch or rash associated with anaphylaxis, provided all systemic signs of anaphylaxis are improving.

Contraindications

- ✕ Known severe allergy.
- ✕ Age less than one year.

Cautions

- ⚠ Pregnancy.

Use in pregnancy or when breastfeeding

- Safety has not been demonstrated during pregnancy. Because minor allergic reactions rarely require specific treatment, the balance of risk is such that loratadine should usually be withheld.
- May be administered if the patient is breastfeeding. Advise the patient to stop breastfeeding and seek further advice from their lead maternity carer or GP.

Dosage

- 20 mg for an adult or child aged greater than or equal to 12 years.

Loratadine

- 10 mg for a child aged 1-11 years.

Administration

- Administer PO.
- Always ask a parent (or guardian) if a young child can swallow tablets. Loratadine may be crushed and placed in a soft food such as jam or honey.

Common adverse effects

- None.

Usual onset of effect

- 30-60 minutes.

Usual duration of effect

- 12-24 hours.

Usual preparation

- 10 mg tablets.

Pharmacokinetics

- Loratadine is predominantly metabolised by the liver.
- There are no significant effects from liver impairment on acute administration.

Common interactions

- None.
- Increases in plasma concentrations of loratadine have been reported after concurrent administration of ketoconazole, erythromycin and roxithromycin. In a small number of patients this was associated with a prolonged QT interval, but this only occurred with long-term administration.

Loratadine

Additional information

- All personnel (including those without ATP) may give loratadine to a patient for self-administration, provided the package instructions are followed.

More Information

Version history

28 October 2024 1.0.5

Update: Dosage updated.